

MZ UCA Cloud Academy

AWS Solutions Architect Associate (SAA)

Governance Review

AWS Organizations, Service Control Policies (SCPs), Landing Zones & Multi-Account Strategy

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Cloud Governance Architect

◆ **PURPOSE OF THIS REVIEW**

A Cloud Engineer asks:

"Can this be deployed?"

A Solutions Architect asks:

"How should this be deployed?"

A Cloud Governance Architect asks:

"How should this be controlled, secured, governed, and scaled?"

This review is designed to help you evaluate cloud environments from a governance perspective rather than a purely technical perspective.

◆ **GOVERNANCE ASSESSMENT SCENARIO**

Organization

Ubuntu Retail Group (URG)

Current State

URG currently operates:

- ✓ One AWS Account
- ✓ 35 Employees
- ✓ Development Team
- ✓ Finance Team
- ✓ Security Team
- ✓ Production Workloads
- ✓ Customer Data
- ✓ Shared Administration

Existing Challenges

- ✗ All workloads share one AWS account
- ✗ Developers have excessive permissions
- ✗ No SCPs implemented
- ✗ No Landing Zone
- ✗ No account separation
- ✗ No governance model
- ✗ Limited cost visibility

Governance Question

Would you approve this architecture?

☐ YES

☐ NO

Explain your reasoning.

◆ GOVERNANCE CHECKPOINT 1

AWS ORGANIZATIONS

Review Question

The company operates:

Development

Production

Security

Finance

Workloads

inside one AWS account.

Governance Assessment

1. What governance risks exist?

1. How would AWS Organizations improve governance?

Governance Decision

☐ Accept Current Design

☐ Implement AWS Organizations

Justify your answer.

GOVERNANCE CHECKPOINT 2

ORGANIZATIONAL UNITS (OUs)

Scenario

The company creates:

Production OU

Development OU

Security OU

Sandbox OU

Review Questions

1. Why is this structure beneficial?

1. Which workloads belong in each OU?

Production OU

Development OU

Security OU

Sandbox OU

Governance Perspective

How does workload separation improve security?

GOVERNANCE CHECKPOINT 3

SERVICE CONTROL POLICIES (SCPs)

Scenario

Developers currently have permission to:

- ✓ Create Resources
 - ✓ Delete Resources
 - ✓ Disable Security Services
 - ✓ Disable CloudTrail
 - ✓ Modify Security Controls
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Review Question

Would this be acceptable in a governed environment?

☐ YES

☐ NO

Explain why.

Governance Recommendation

Identify three actions that should be restricted through SCPs.

1. _____
 2. _____
 3. _____
-

Critical Governance Rule

SCPs establish organizational guardrails.

GOVERNANCE CHECKPOINT 4

LANDING ZONE MATURITY

Scenario A

AWS accounts created manually.

No standards.

No centralized logging.

No security baseline.

No governance controls.

Governance Rating

☐ Poor

☐ Fair

☐ Good

☐ Excellent

Explain.

Scenario B

Landing Zone implemented.

Centralized logging.

Security controls deployed.

IAM standards established.

Compliance monitoring enabled.

Governance Rating

☐ Poor

☐ Fair

☐ Good

☐ Excellent

Explain.

◆ GOVERNANCE CHECKPOINT 5

MULTI-ACCOUNT STRATEGY

Scenario

URG creates the following accounts:

Production Account

Development Account

Testing Account

Security Account

Shared Services Account

Log Archive Account

Sandbox Account

Review Question

What governance benefits are gained?

Select all that apply.

- ☐ Better Security
 - ☐ Cost Isolation
 - ☐ Reduced Blast Radius
 - ☐ Improved Compliance
 - ☐ Easier Auditing
 - ☐ Better Team Ownership
 - ☐ Improved Operational Control
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Governance Reflection

Why is account isolation considered an AWS best practice?

◆ GOVERNANCE CHECKPOINT 6

THE BLAST RADIUS TEST

Scenario

A developer accidentally deletes resources.

Environment A

Single AWS Account

Production and Development combined.

Impact:

Environment B

Separate Production and Development Accounts.

Impact:

Governance Analysis

Which architecture better limits the blast radius?

Why?



GOVERNANCE CHECKPOINT 7

CONSOLIDATED BILLING REVIEW

Scenario

The company operates:

Production Account

\$3,500

Development Account

\$1,200

Security Account

\$600

Sandbox Account

\$200

Questions

1. Total Monthly Cost

1. Which AWS Organizations feature simplifies this management?

1. Why is centralized billing valuable?

◆ GOVERNANCE CHECKPOINT 8

ARCHITECTURAL DECISION REVIEW

For each statement, determine whether it reflects good governance.

Statement 1

All teams share one AWS account.

☐ Approved

☐ Not Approved

Reason:

Statement 2

Production and Development are isolated.

☐ Approved

☐ Not Approved

Reason:

Statement 3

CloudTrail can be disabled by Developers.

☐ Approved

☐ Not Approved

Reason:

Statement 4

SCPs prevent deletion of security services.

☐ Approved

☐ Not Approved

Reason:

Statement 5

Landing Zone deployed before workloads.

☐ Approved

☐ Not Approved

Reason:

GOVERNANCE MATURITY SCORECARD

Evaluate the organization.

Governance Area	Score (1-5)
Security	_____
Governance	_____
Compliance	_____
Cost Control	_____
Operational Control	_____
Scalability	_____
Risk Management	_____

Total Score

__ / 35

Maturity Rating

30–35

✓ Enterprise Ready

24–29

✓ Strong Governance

18–23

✓ Moderate Governance

10–17

✓ Needs Improvement

Below 10

✓ High Risk Environment

EXECUTIVE GOVERNANCE REVIEW

As the Cloud Governance Architect, provide your recommendation.

Would you approve the current architecture for enterprise deployment?

☐ YES

☐ NO

Executive Summary

◆ THINK LIKE A CLOUD GOVERNANCE ARCHITECT

Before approving any AWS environment ask:

- ◆ Is governance centralized?
 - ◆ Are workloads isolated?
 - ◆ Are security controls protected?
 - ◆ Is compliance enforceable?
 - ◆ Is cost visibility available?
 - ◆ Is blast radius minimized?
 - ◆ Can this architecture scale safely?
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◆ FINAL TAKEAWAY

Technology creates capability.

Architecture creates structure.

Governance creates trust.

Organizations that scale successfully in the cloud do not rely on technology alone.

They build repeatable governance mechanisms that protect the business as it grows.

MZ UCA GOVERNANCE PRINCIPLE

"Control before scale.

Governance before growth.

Architecture before deployment."

Zulu Mthulisi

Cloud Governance Architect

MZ UCA Cloud Academy

Building Architects. Establishing Governance. Creating Leaders.